

Introduction

This contract outlines the expectations and responsibilities of umpires serving in the Tri-Valley Baseball Association. As an umpire, you play a critical role in ensuring fair play, safety, and a positive experience for players, coaches, and spectators. By agreeing to this contract, you commit to upholding the standards of professionalism, integrity, and respect that our association values.

Expectations and Responsibilities

1. Knowledge of Rules - <https://www.minndak.org/rules/>
 1. Umpires are expected to have a thorough understanding of the official rules of baseball as adopted by the league, including any local modifications.
 2. Umpires must review the MinnDak's rulebook prior to the season and attend any provided training sessions.
2. Game Preparation
 1. Arrive at the field **at least 15 minutes** before the scheduled game time.
 2. Arrive with all necessary equipment gathered from the shed (e.g., mask, chest protector, ball/strike counter) and return at the completion of the game.
 3. Wear age-appropriate apparel.
 1. **NO SHIRTS PROMOTING ALCOHOL, DRUGS, or TOBACCO** are to be worn.
 2. **NO SHIRTS WITH SUGGESTIVE OR VULGAR LANGUAGE** are to be worn.
 3. **NO FLIP-FLOPS!** Closed-toe shoes must be worn at all bases.
 4. Shorts ARE allowed.
 4. Inspect the field for safety hazards and ensure game equipment (e.g., pitching mound, bases, home plate) is properly set up according to the age specifications.
3. Professional Conduct
 1. Maintain a **calm, impartial, and respectful** demeanor at all times, regardless of the actions of players, coaches, or spectators.
 2. **Avoid arguing** with participants or engaging in confrontational behavior.
 3. Use **clear, concise communication** when making calls or addressing questions.

Game Management and Focus

4. Enforce the rules **consistently** and fairly, **without bias** toward any team.
5. Conduct a pregame plate visit with coaches from **BOTH TEAMS** and the base umpire.
 1. Set the precedent of expected behavior.
 2. Set the precedent of strike zone, as well as the third base open/closed rule.
 3. Call out any field hazards or rules.
 1. Ball under backstop
 2. Ball through the open gate in outfield
6. Manage the pace of the game to ensure it progresses smoothly and stays on schedule.
7. Remain fully focused and attentive throughout the game.
 1. Position yourself appropriately on the field to have the best vantage point for making accurate calls.
 2. Avoid distractions or lapses in concentration, including the avoidance of interacting with friends/family that may be attending the game.
 3. Demonstrate alertness by anticipating plays and reacting promptly, ensuring no action on the field goes unnoticed.
8. Safety
 1. Prioritize the safety of all participants by monitoring weather conditions, player behavior, and equipment use.
 2. Stop play immediately if unsafe conditions arise (e.g., lightning, serious injury) and follow league safety protocols.
9. Interaction with Participants

1. Treat players, coaches, and parents with respect, recognizing that this is a youth sports environment focused on development and fun.
 2. Handle disputes or rule clarifications promptly and confidently, referring to association officials if necessary, while maintaining composure and authority.
 3. Responses to inappropriate behavior may include, but are not limited to, warnings, ejections, or incident reports for follow-up by the association.
 4. In any event where an individual was removed from an event, the association umpire representative must be contacted immediately following the game, and an incident report will be completed.
10. Cell Phone Policy During Games
1. **Umpires are prohibited from using cell phones or other personal electronic devices for non-emergency purposes during games, including texting, browsing, or taking calls.**
 2. Cell phones may be used only during breaks (e.g., between innings) for emergencies or to contact association officials if necessary.
 3. Devices must be kept on silent or vibrate mode and stored out of sight (e.g., in a pocket or bag) while actively umpiring to maintain focus on the game.

Availability and Commitment

11. Commit to the agreed-upon schedule of games and notify the association coordinator at least **48 hours in advance** if unable to officiate.
12. Attend any mandatory umpire meetings or training sessions scheduled by the association.
13. Substitute Requirement
 1. If unable to officiate a game you have signed up for, you are responsible for finding a qualified substitute umpire from the association's approved umpire roster and notify the association coordinator.
 2. The substitute must be confirmed with the association coordinator at least 24 hours prior to the game, barring emergencies.
 3. Failure to secure a substitute may result in forfeiture of payment for that game or other disciplinary action, at the discretion of the association.

Compensation

14. Umpires will be compensated as follows:
 1. Regular season games use a single plate umpire only, with parent volunteers for the base path.
 2. Umpires will be paid \$40 per game for plate umpiring during the regular season.
 3. Base umpires are not paid during the regular season.
 4. Payment will be made (by check) once at the midpoint of the season, and again following the completion of the season, contingent upon fulfilling the responsibilities outlined in this contract.
 5. Tournament pay (if any), will be determined by tournament officials before the tournament is scheduled.

Umpire Contact Information

Name: _____

Address: _____

Phone: _____

Email: _____

Parent Contact Information (if under 18)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Phone: _____

Email: _____

Acknowledgment

I, agree to abide by the expectations and responsibilities outlined in this contract while serving as an umpire for the Tri-Valley Baseball Association. I understand that violations may result in disciplinary action, including removal from the umpire roster and forfeiture of future games.

Signature: _____
(Umpire)

Date: _____

Signature: _____
(Association Representative)

Date: _____